SOUTH MARSTON
PARISH COUNCIL

SMPC Response to S/COND/22/0711

Surface Water Management Plan

The Parish Council has an overarching concern which applies to this application but is also relevant to the other recent revisions of HHT S/OUT/13/1555 Reserved Matters – the Strategic Design Code, the A420 signalised junction and the FLEAMP.

Development will come forward by detailed applications for development parcels ie sub-phases, whilst all the timing of delivery of relevant infrastructure is tied to the main phases as stated in the agreed Phasing Details (reserved matter discharged in August 2022). Without clarity on which infrastructure will be in place at each sub-phase of development, it is not possible to guarantee the proposals are sustainable at any time during the build-out of South Marston Village in particular.

In general, the Parish Council appreciates the efforts made within the revised Surface Water document to ensure our initial concerns on Surface Water drainage and flood risk are addressed. We are happy with the overall proposals, apart from the comments as indicated below. Of these, our major concern is the sequencing of implementation and if this is not satisfactorily addressed, then we **Object** to the proposals.

Sequencing of Implementation

Whereas there is a clear intention on the sequence of implementation, this is stated by 'phase'. Unfortunately, Phase 1 at South Marston includes multiple sub-phases/reserved matters applications for road construction etc, each of which has a reliance on the overall Surface Water Drainage Strategy proposals. In particular, we need clarity in the document over the following:

- The Strategy should clarify that **sub-phase 1** related works ('Nightingale Corner) relies on, at a minimum, all the work on the north/south drainage channel from Bridleway 4 southward, roadside ditches along OVL and the main detention Basin A. This is important since we may just have a completed Haul Road and sub-phase 1 housing parcel in place for many years before any other development plots in the overall Phase 1 come forward for development.
- **Use of or replacement of existing ditch network** - The Strategy states that existing ditches will be cleared or infilled as appropriate – we believe this Strategy should state that each sub-phase detailed application should clearly identify what is to happen to existing ditches which are affected by or impact on that sub-phase.

  This includes for instance, OVL roadside ditches taking flow of water southward from the Bellway development to the Carpenters – clearance of these should be completed in the earliest **sub-phase**, including connectivity with the planned drainage channels and pipes associations with the OVL/Primary Street junction.

The photos below taken on 15.01.23 show the scale of the problem on OVL opposite to the Phase 1 development.

- We also believe **Basin A** needs to be constructed as part of the Haul Rd 'sub-phase' for the following reasons.

  We are concerned about surface water flows south of the Construction Compound on the OVL end of the Haul Rd – the only measures mentioned in the relevant Haul Rd application appear to be a small roadside depression (see Haul Rd cross-section) that presumably flows into the ground/ existing ditch network. However, given the volume of groundwater flow at this point, this area of the site is likely to be under water in even medium rainfall.

  Whereas silt capture measures are planned and road sweeping disposal are mentioned, the Haul Rd applications focus on wheel-washing at the Thornhill Road end. '*The Consortium as Client will ensure that pro-active measures are taken to prevent slurry/spoil being deposited on the public highway from vehicles leaving site during the works. The measures taken will also extend to Old Vicarage Lane, although it is <u>highly unlikely that such measures</u> will be needed at this location (para 2.2.4. CEMP Haul Rd)'.*

  This is inconsistent with the application for the OVL/Haul Rd junction OVL (a separate, but complementary application), which includes heavy construction traffic working across Old Vicarage Lane to create the two Rowborough road access junctions.
  In summary, we cannot see how the Haul Rd and junction construction at the OVL end can work without the existing ditch network being cleared and prior construction of Basin A , together with appropriate measures to ensure silt and road debris does not enter either Basin A or the local watercourses.

- **Carpenters Arms culvert and related investigation on dredging/clearance of ditches** – the Strategy should make clear that this should happen as part of the OVL/A420 junction works

Exceedance flooding

We appreciate the work on exceedance levels and plans for coping with this within the latest report In. However, very few surface water technical studies in recent years have correctly identified the sheer volume of surface water travelling west to east through fields as well as in ditches in times of extreme rainfall which now happen every year.

As an additional safeguard, we would advise that the main drainage channel north to south should be designed to enable a further overflow area on its banks which would minimise impact on use of green infrastructure areas e.g. the footpaths and walkways within public open space.

Similarly, footpaths/cycleway routes should be safeguarded from exceedance flooding immediately north of the railway line in South Marston. We suggest an increase in capacity of the drainage Basin A should be enabled, possibly by having shallow sides at its western/northern end, bearing in mind that this should be well clear of the space required for planned Haul Rd construction site activity.

Interim Maintenance of SUDs areas

We assume that the construction of the SUDs infrastructure across the site will be subject to an interim maintenance regime during the build-out. The FLEAMP indicates there will be LEAMP reserved matters to be agreed at each detailed application. We are concerned that there must be a plan for the overarching maintenance of the SUDs infrastructure that is not divided up between management entities, either in interim stages of build, or when development is completed. An aspiration should be noted in the Surface Water Report for comprehensive and integrated management of SUDs infrastructure.at each stage of development.

Technical Note para 2.14 – Culvert under Bridleway 4

Contrary to what is said, the consortium does own the bridleway or will do before sub-phase 1 has begun, so is able to do the work necessary to complete the strategic north/south drainage channel.

We would also point out that maintenance of the ditches mentioned above are the landowner's responsibility irrespective of the phased buildout, and the landowner is or will be the consortium.

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